

IT Asset & Security SOP

Standard Operating Procedure for Hardware, Software, and Network Security

1. Introduction

This document establishes the Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) for the provisioning, usage, and lifecycle management of IT assets at NovaTech Industries. It also outlines the foundational security mandates every employee must follow to protect corporate data and intellectual property.

2. Hardware Allocation Matrix

Devices are strictly allocated based on departmental requirements and specific job roles to ensure optimal performance without unnecessary expenditure. Deviations or upgrades require VP-level approval and a documented business justification.

Role / Department	Standard Device Model	Compute Specs (RAM/Storage)	Approved Peripherals
Engineering & Data Science	Apple MacBook Pro 16" (M3 Max)	64GB RAM / 1TB SSD	2x 27" 4K Monitors, Apple Magic Keyboard, MX Master Mouse
Product, UI/UX Design	Apple MacBook Pro 14" (M3 Pro)	32GB RAM / 512GB SSD	1x 32" 4K Monitor, Wacom Intuos Pro Tablet (optional)
Sales & Field Marketing	Dell Latitude 7440 OR MacBook Air 13"	16GB RAM / 512GB SSD	1x 24" Monitor, Jabra Evolve Wireless Headset
HR, Finance, Operations	Dell Latitude 5440	16GB RAM / 256GB SSD	1x 24" Monitor, Standard Dell Keyboard/Mouse combo

3. Asset Lifecycle, Maintenance & Offboarding

The standard lifecycle for all primary compute devices is **36 months**. Upon reaching the 36-month mark, employees will receive an automated Jira Service Desk notification prompting them to select a replacement device from the current catalog. Old devices must be returned to IT within 14 days of receiving the new machine.

Offboarding: Upon termination or resignation, all company-provided hardware must be returned on or before the final working day. Failure to return assets will result in a deduction from the final settlement equivalent to the depreciated value of the hardware.

4. Software Procurement

All software used for company business must be licensed and approved. Employees needing new software must submit a "Software Request Ticket" in Jira. The IT Security team reviews all requests for SOC2 compliance, data privacy risks, and single sign-on (SSO/Okta) compatibility before purchasing licenses.

5. Incident Reporting SLAs

The IT Helpdesk operates across three global time zones (Follow-the-Sun model) and adheres to the following Service Level Agreements:

Priority Level	Issue Type Example	Initial Response	Resolution Target
P1 - Critical	Device lost/stolen, Ransomware, Major security breach	15 minutes	4 hours
P2 - High	Hardware failure preventing work, Account lockout	1 hour	Next Business Day (NBD) replacement
P3 - Normal	New software installation, accessory requests, minor bugs	4 hours	3 Business Days

CRITICAL SECURITY MANDATE: If a laptop or mobile device containing company data is lost or stolen, it must be reported to security@novatech.local immediately (and no later than 2 hours of discovery). IT will initiate remote wipe protocols via our Mobile Device Management (MDM) platform. Do not attempt to recover a stolen device yourself.

6. Network Security and VPN Usage

When working remotely or on untrusted public Wi-Fi (e.g., airports, coffee shops), employees **MUST** use the corporate VPN (GlobalProtect) to access any internal systems. Split-tunneling is disabled by default to ensure all traffic is inspected by our cloud firewall.

Password Policy: NovaTech utilizes Okta for SSO. Your master Okta password must be at least 14 characters long, include a mix of character types, and must not have been found in any known public data breaches. Passwords expire every 90 days. Biometric authentication (TouchID/Windows Hello) is highly recommended.

7. Acceptable Use Policy

- Company devices are provided primarily for business use. Reasonable personal use (e.g., checking personal email, reading news) is permitted provided it does not interfere with work duties or violate security policies.

- Downloading pirated/unlicensed software, using BitTorrent, or accessing explicit, illegal, or hate-speech content is strictly prohibited. Web traffic is actively filtered and logged via Zscaler.
- To prevent data exfiltration, USB mass storage devices (thumb drives, external hard drives) are blocked globally by CrowdStrike. Exceptions are extremely rare and require VP IT approval and a specific security ticket.